



YOU SAID IT



Include both 32-bit and 64-bit software on the bundled DVD

I have been reading *LFY* (now *OSFY*) for a very long time. Let me congratulate you on providing readers an excellent platform to learn Linux and open source software. It will not be an exaggeration to say that I have learnt a lot by reading your magazine—much more than from books. I am sure there are a lot of open source fans who love the content of *OSFY*. Please keep up the good work. I also wanted to mention that there is always a dispute on whether it should be 32-bit or 64-bit software on the CD/DVD that you bundle with the magazine every month. Is it not possible to have both 32-and 64-bit software on a single DVD? This would be indeed welcome.

—S Auluck,
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ED: Thanks for the wonderful feedback! Such enthusiastic mails help us to do even better. Yes, it is definitely feasible to have both 32-bit and 64-bit on a single DVD and, in fact, it is something we have done before. For example, last year, our May 2012 edition with the *Gentoo* live DVD had both 32-and 64-bit software. So was the case with our June 2012 *Ubuntu*-DVD. We have taken note of your suggestion. Till then, keep reading *OSFY* and continue sending us your valuable inputs.



A wish-list for *OSFY*

I recently received the current issue of *OSFY*. And I'd like to say a few words:

1. As a regular reader of your magazine, right from Issue 1, I have been trying the various flavours of Linux. They helped me a lot professionally. Mine is an old computer with 810 VGA. Except for Fedora and Ubuntu, I could not run the distros most of the time. I had problems even with Mint. It is surprising that such a vibrant Linux community is not able to provide a simple VGA driver so that booting in Linux is possible just like in Windows. Although I am not qualified to comment on such a knowledgeable group, I wonder whether it is really that difficult to add such a simple driver.
2. Second, I tried PC Linux OS and Arch. I could run the former only in 'safe' mode, which stopped at the terminal. When I tried Arch Linux from the USB stick (after running the 'dd' command in Ubuntu), all I saw was a text file. Obviously, I need to install it step-by-step, which is somewhat risky unless one has a separate HDD for this purpose. And besides, this will be time-consuming. In one of my earlier letters, I requested that a simple write-up on the DVD's contents would be helpful. But sadly, this hasn't appeared in the magazine. Such an article would have been useful. My experiment with 'Snowlinux' has

not worked out. Perhaps, I need to spend more time on it.

In the light of these thoughts and suggestions, for a long time, I have felt that most of the articles are geared towards only developers. But what about students, newcomers or hobbyists who would like to know about new developments or use the computer for fun? Apart from the 'Regular Features', there were only two articles — 'A Look at the Basics of LVM' and 'Kickstarting Virtualisation with Virtual Box' — in the last issue that were useful for the ordinary reader. Perhaps, I am from a minority. However, you may like to solicit the views from other readers on this matter.

I shall remain a subscriber of *OSFY* till the end. In fact, yours is the only magazine I subscribe to nowadays. Earlier, I used to receive half a dozen magazines every month.

—V S Nagasayanam,
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ED: Let me take this opportunity of thanking you for going through our magazine and sending us such insightful feedback. It also feels good to know that the Linux flavours that we bundle with *OSFY* have been useful to you. So, let me answer your queries, one by one.

- 1) We would suggest that you post this query on our Facebook page https://www.facebook.com/OpenSourceForU?ref=tn_inmn#/OpenSourceForU and you would get a lot of suggestions from our FB community. Else, you can contact the Linux User Groups and put forth your query. We are sure this will help you too.
 - 2) Our April 2013 issue's DVD on *OpenSuse* 12.3 had the details about the basic installation of the DVD. You can have a look at it.
 - 3) Yes, you do have a valid point about the magazine needing to cater to a wider audience. We try our best to feature articles for beginners too. It's all about balancing everyone's interests, in our editions.
- Thanks again for sending us a great feedback. Keep them coming.



Loved reading 'Will certifications related to FOSS...'

I was really impressed with the article 'Will certifications related to FOSS help you get a job?' published in the April 2013 issue of *OSFY*. I feel that FOSS beginners and students should read it once, as they start their career in the open source domain. It was interesting to read the write-up as it had a bunch of suggestions from Linux pioneers and open source communities. Looking forward to more such articles in your forthcoming issues.

—T Nagaraja,
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